

Chapter-13

Tenses

Read the following sentences carefully.

1. I was a child **a few years ago**.
2. I am a youngster **now**.
3. I shall be old in **future**.

The above three sentences refer to a state of being or existence at three different points of time. The verb 'was' refers to existence in the past. The verb 'am' refers to existence in the present. The verb 'shall be' refers to existence at some time in future.

Let's take some more examples.

1. He wore a pink shirt **yesterday**.
2. He is wearing a black shirt **today**.
3. He will wear a white shirt **tomorrow**.

The verbs 'wore', 'is wearing' and 'will wear' in the above sentences refer to actions in the past, present and future time respectively.

The word 'tense' has been derived from the Latin word 'tempus' which means time. The tense is a verb form that shows the time of action or event. It also indicates the state of an action.

There are three Tenses.

1. Present Tense
2. Past Tense
3. Future Tense

Sub Divisions of Tenses

Each tense is further sub-divided in four tenses according to the time of actions they denote. These sub divisions are:

1. **Indefinite or Simple:** A verb in simple or indefinite tense denotes an action that does not refer to any specific time.
2. **Continuous:** A verb in continuous tense denotes an action in progress.
3. **Perfect:** A verb in perfect tense denotes a complete action.
4. **Perfect Continuous:** A verb in perfect continuous tense denotes an action in progress for some time.

Study the table given below to understand the division of each tense. The table shows all the tense forms of the verb 'write'.

	Present	Past	Future
Simple	He writes a letter.	He wrote a letter	He will write a letter.
Continuous	He is writing a letter	He was writing a letter.	He will be writing a letter.
Perfect	He has written a letter.	He had written a letter.	He will have written a letter
Perfect Continuous	He has been writing a letter since morning.	He had been writing a letter for 10 minutes.	He will have been writing a letter since morning.

Exercise: Use the verb 'wash' and complete the table given below using the correct tense.

1. Simple Present
2. Simple Past
3. Simple Future
4. Present Continuous
5. Past Continuous
6. Future Continuous

7. Present Perfect
8. Past Perfect
9. Future Perfect
10. Present Perfect Continuous
11. Past Perfect Continuous
12. Future Perfect Continuous

Simple Present Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern: Subject + I form of Verb (s/es)

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He/She/It/Singular Subject+ First form of verb+ s/es I/We/You/They/Plural Subject+First form of verb	He writes a letter. They play cricket.
Negative Sentences:	He/She/It/Singular Subject+ does not+ First form of verb I/We/You/They/Plural Subject+do not+ First form of verb	He does not write a letter. They do not play cricket.
Interrogative Sentences	Does+ He/She/It/Singular Subject+ First form of verb Do+ I/We/ You/They/Plural Subject+ First form of verb	Does he write a letter? Do they play cricket?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Does+ He/She/It/Singular Subject+ not+ First form of verb Do+ I/We/ You/They/Plural Subject+not+ First form of verb	Does he not write a letter? Do they not play cricket?

Use of Simple Present Tense

1. To express universal truths and facts such as a scientific fact, mathematical fact, geographical fact etc:

- ⇒ The earth revolves around the sun.
- ⇒ Water boils at 100 degree centigrade.
- ⇒ Two and two make four.

2. To express a habitual action, routines, customs, traditions etc:

- ⇒ He always speaks the truth.
- ⇒ People celebrate Diwali to mark the return of Lord Rama from exile.
- ⇒ Most men in the Punjab wear turbans.
- ⇒ My mother goes to temple every day.

3. To express proverbial statements:

- ⇒ Honesty is the best policy.
- ⇒ Riches have wings.
- ⇒ Early to bed and early to rise, makes a man healthy, wealthy and wise.

4. For live commentaries:

- ⇒ Rajeev passes the ball to Nitish, Nitish passes it to Arjun who heads towards the goal and scores a goal.

5. To denote a planned future action:

- ⇒ Our school reopens next week.
- ⇒ The match begins the next hour.

6. In news paper headlines:

- ⇒ Cricket match between Srilanka and England ends in a draw.
- ⇒ Peace talk between India and Pakistan fails.

7. To quote poets or authors whether living or dead:

- ⇒ Shakespeare says, "Sweet are the uses of adversity."

8. In subordinate clauses (starting with if, in case, provided that, unless, till, until, as soon as, when, before etc.) showing time or condition when the main clause is in the future: (type-1 conditional sentences)

- ⇒ If it rains, we will not go out.
- ⇒ When my father comes home, we shall play chess.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with simple present tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

1. The sun.....(rise) in the east and.....(set) in the west.
2. Oil.....(float) on water.
3. Children.....(like) sweets.
4. My father.....(go) for a walk every day.
5. He always.....(come) late to the class.
6. The earth.....(be) round.
7.(do) he.....(have) a big house?
8. We(visit) a hill station once a year.
9. I hope she.....(come) back safely.
10. There..... (go) the bell!
11. Rahul never.....(tell) a lie.
12. I will attend the party if he.....(invite) me.
13. I.....(not like) mangoes.
14. He.....(not attend) the class regularly.
15. He will not pass unless he.....(work) hard.

Simple Past Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern : Subject+ II form of Verb

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He /She/It/Singular Subject/ I/We/You/They/Plural Subject+ Second form of verb	He wrote a letter. They played cricket.
Negative Sentences:	He/ She/It/Singular Subject/ I/We/You/They/Plural Subject+ did not+ First form of verb	He did not write a letter. They did not play cricket.
Interrogative Sentences	Did+ He /She/It/Singular Subject/I/We/You/They/Plural Subject+ First form of verb	Did he write a letter? Did they play cricket?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Did+ He/ She/It/Singular Subject/ I/We/ You /They/ Plural Subject+ not+ First form of verb	Did he not write a letter? Did they not play cricket?

Use of Simple Past Tense

1. To denote an action or situation that occurred or completed in the past: The actions denoting past tense have no connection with present.

- ⇒ I went to market yesterday.
- ⇒ Last year we visited the Taj Mahal.
- ⇒ The train arrived late by twenty minutes.

2. To denote actions that happened for a period of time in the past and completed in the past:

- ✧ She stayed with us for a week.
- ✧ They spent ten years in Chennai.

3. To denote habitual actions, routines or customs of the past (for past habits, the use of 'used to' and 'would' is discussed in the chapter dealing with modal auxiliaries):

- ✧ When I was a student, I played cricket.
- ✧ Early man lived in forest.
- ✧ They always came late.

4. To talk about discoveries, inventions achievements etc:

- ✧ Columbus discovered America.
- ✧ Thomas Edison invented electric bulb.

5. In type-2 conditional sentences:

- ✧ If I went to Jaipur, I would visit the Hawa Mahal.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with simple past tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

1. It.....yesterday. (rain)
2. We.....(shift) here last week.
3. When I was a student, I always.....(complete) my homework on time.
4.(do) he.....(get) married last month?
5. Ithis car in Delhi. (buy)
6. I wish I.....(can) help her.
7. He.....(not take) the test on Saturday as he was not well.
8. Ashoka.....(be) a great king.
9. India.....(get) freedom in 1947.
10. If I.....(win) the prize, I would be rich.

Simple Future Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern Subject +will/shall+ I form of Verb

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject + will+ First form of verb I/We + shall/will+ First form of verb	He will write a letter. They will play cricket. I shall/will write a letter.
Negative Sentences:	He/ She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject + will+ not+ First form of verb I/We + shall/will+ not+ First form of verb	He will not write a letter. They will not play cricket. I shall/will not write a letter.
Interrogative Sentences	Will+ He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject + First form of verb Shall+ I/We + First form of verb	Will he write a letter? Will they play cricket? Shall I write a letter?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Will+ He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject + not+ First form of Verb Shall+ I/We + not+ First form of verb	Will he not write a letter? Will they not play cricket? Shall I not write a letter?

Use of Simple Future Tense

1. To describe a future action or event:

- ✍ We will go for a picnic tomorrow.
- ✍ The marriage will take place the next month.

2. To make an offer or promise:

- ✍ He shall get a prize tomorrow.
- ✍ I will buy you a new toy.

3. In main clauses when the subordinate clauses show time and condition and start with if, in case, provided that, unless, till, until, as soon as, when, before etc:

- ✍ If you complete your work, I will let you play. (type-1 conditional sentences)
- ✍ When my mother comes home, we will take dinner.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with simple future tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

1. The teacher us a test tomorrow. (give)
2. you (visit) us the next month?
3. I have decided that I never a lie again. (tell)
4. If you follow my instructions carefully, you (find) the treasure.
5. I wonder what he in his life. (do)
6. I expect, India (win) the test series.
7. They not (play) a cricket match in the evening.
8. The Principal is on leave today. The Vice-Principal (preside) over the meeting.
9. I have planned that I (spend) my vacation at Manali.
10. We (celebrate) our annual function at the end of the session.

Present Continuous Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern: Subject + is/am/are+ I form of Verb + ing

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He/She/It/Singular Subject+ is+ First form of verb+ ing I+ am+ First form of verb+ ing We/ You/They/Plural Subject+ are+ First form of verb + ing	He is writing a letter. I am writing a letter. They are playing cricket.
Negative Sentences:	He/She/It/Singular Subject+ is + not+ First form of verb + ing I+ am + not+ First form of verb+ ing We/ You/They/Plural Subject+ are + not+ First form of verb+ ing	He is not writing a letter. I am not writing a letter. They are not playing cricket.
Interrogative Sentences	Is+ He/ She/It/Singular Subject+ First form of verb+ ing Am+ I+ First form of verb+ ing Are+ We/ You/They/Plural Subject+ First form of verb + ing	Is he writing a letter? Am I writing a letter? Are they playing cricket?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Is+ He/ She/It/Singular Subject+ not+ First form of verb+ ing Am+ I+ not + First form of verb+ ing Are+ We/You/They/Plural Subject+ not +First form of verb + ing	Is he not writing a letter? Am I not writing a letter? Are they not playing cricket?

Use of Present Continuous Tense

1. To denote an action in progress at the time of speaking:

- ✧ I am going to school.
- ✧ The boys are playing cricket in the stadium.
- ✧ My mother is cooking food.

2. To denote an action in progress and continuity around present time, not necessarily at the time of speaking:

- ✧ I am learning French these days.
- ✧ India is progressing by leaps and bounds.
- ✧ She is writing a book.

3. Planned future actions:

- ✧ We are going to play a cricket match this evening.
- ✧ They are meeting tonight.

4. Use of 'will' and 'be going to' for future actions

Both 'will' and 'be going to' are used to denote future actions. However, there is a difference between the two. We use 'will' when we plan to do something at the time of speaking. On the other hand, 'be going to' is used to denote actions that are planned or actions that are likely to happen.

- ✧ My friend is going to get married. (planned action)
- ✧ She will get married after her Ph.D. (not planned as yet)
- ✧ Sumit is riding his bicycle carelessly. He is going to fall. (action likely to happen)
- ✧ Look at the clouds in the sky. It's going to rain.
- ✧ I don't have money to buy a car. I will take a loan from bank.
- ✧ I am going to take loan from bank. (already planned) or, I am taking loan from bank.

Use of Simple Present and Present Continuous

Simple Present	Present Continuous
I go to school at 7. (routine)	I am going to school. (now)
I have a big house.	I am having dinner.
The sun rises in the east.	The sun is rising; it's looking beautiful.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with present continuous tense or simple present tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

1. Where.....you.....at this time? (go)
2. I(learn) driving these days.
3. She usually a saree, but today she(wear) a suit.
4. Due to bad weather, the trains.....late. (run)
5. I.....my lawyer this evening. (see)
6. Rajan always.....(fight) with his classmates.
7. Prices.....(rise) rapidly.
8. Life.....(become) tough day by day.
9. Look at that speeding car, it.....(be, go) to hit someone.
10. She.....(work) very hard.

Past Continuous Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern: Subject+ was/were +I form of Verb+ ing

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	I/ He/She/It/Singular Subject+ was+ First form of verb+ ing We/ You/They/Plural Subject+ were+ First form of verb + ing	He was writing a letter. I was writing a letter. They were playing cricket.
Negative Sentences:	I/ He/She/It/Singular Subject+ was + not+ First form of verb+ ing We/ You/They/Plural Subject+ were + not+ First form of verb + ing	He was not writing a letter. I was not writing a letter. They were not playing cricket.
Interrogative Sentences	Was+ I/ He/She/It/Singular Subject+ First form of verb+ ing Were+ We/ You/They/Plural Subject+ First form of verb + ing	Was he writing a letter? Was I writing a letter? Were they playing cricket?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Was+ I/He/She/It/Singular Subject+ not+ First form of verb+ ing Were+ We/You/They/Plural Subject+ not +First form of verb +ing	Was he not writing a letter? Was I not writing a letter? Were they not playing cricket?

Use of Past Continuous Tense

1. To denote an action which was happening at a particular time in the past:

- ✦ He was playing at 5 o' clock in the evening.
- ✦ Yesterday at 10.00 am, he was travelling to Ludhiana.

2. To denote an action which was in progress when another action happened:

- ✦ When the teacher entered the class, the students were making a noise.
- ✦ It was snowing the whole night.
- ✦ When my father entered the room, my brother was learning his lessons.

3. To express two simultaneous actions:

- ✦ When my brother was playing tennis, I was swimming.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with past continuous tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

1. He.....(study) at 5 o' clock last evening.
2. Yesterday at 11.00 am, she.....(attend) her dance classes.
3. When my mother came home, my sister.....(bake) a cake.
4. When my father.....(work) on a project, my mother
.....(prepare) dinner.
5. The weather.....(turn) cold as the days passed.
6. Those days, I.....(write) a novel.
7. We.....(cross) the road when the accident took place.
8. At this time last year, they.....(construct) their new house.
9. He informed me that he.....(come) late that day.
10. At that time, the postman.....(deliver) letters.

Future Continuous Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern: Subject + will/shall + be + I form of Verb + ing

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject + will+ be+ First form of verb+ ing I/We + shall/will+ be+ First form of verb +ing	He will be writing a letter. I shall/will be writing a letter. They will be playing cricket.
Negative Sentences:	He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject + will+ not+ be+ First form of verb+ ing I/We + shall/will+ not + be+ First form of verb +ing	He will not be writing a letter. I shall/will not be writing a letter. They will not be playing cricket.
Interrogative Sentences	Will+ He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject+ be+ First form of verb+ ing Shall+ I/We + be+ First form of verb +ing	Will he be writing a letter? Shall I be writing a letter? Will they be playing cricket?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Will+ He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject+ not+ be+ First form of verb+ ing Shall+ I/We + not+ be+ First form of verb +ing	Will he not be writing a letter? Shall I not be writing a letter? Will they not be playing cricket?

Use of Future Continuous Tense

1. To denote an action in progress in future:

- ✦ Tomorrow at this time, he will be studying maths.
- ✦ The next week at this time, she will be getting married.

2. To denote plans or arrangements:

- ✦ He will be reaching here by tonight.
- ✦ The aeroplane will be landing soon.

3. To denote an action in progress when another action happens:

- ✦ When he comes back home, his children will be sleeping.
- ✦ If it rains, people will be running here and there.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with future continuous tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

- Next year at this time, we.....(publish) our books.
- At 8:30, I(drive) to office.
- When you come, he.....(have) dinner.
- Next month at this time, they.....(celebrate) New Year at Goa.
- He (inspect) the school tomorrow at this time.
- He is late today. His parents(wait) for him.
- She.....(rehearse) for her dance performance the next week.
- Sara.....(revising) her lessons all evening.
- People.....(prepare) for Christmas next week.
- The farmer(plough) his fields tomorrow morning.

Present Perfect Tense
Subject-Verb Pattern: Subject + has/have + III form of Verb

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He/She/It/Singular Subject+ has+ Third form of verb I/We/You/They/Plural Subject+ have+ Third form of verb	He has written a letter. They have played cricket. I have written a letter.
Negative Sentences:	He/She/It/Singular Subject+ has+ not+ Third form of verb I/We/ You/They/Plural Subject+ have+ not+ Third form of verb	He has not written a letter. They have not played cricket. I have not written a letter.
Interrogative Sentences	Has+ He/She/It/Singular Subject+ Third form of verb Have+ I/We/You/They/Plural Subject+ Third form of verb	Has he written a letter? Have they played cricket? Have I written a letter?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Has+ He/She/It/Singular Subject+ not+ Third form of verb Have+ I/ We/ You/ They/ Plural Subject+ not+ Third form of verb	Has he not written a letter? Have they not played cricket? Have I not written a letter?

Use of Present Perfect Tense

1. To denote a recently completed action:

- ✧ He has just left for the office.
- ✧ I have received your email just now.
- ✧ They have recently purchased a new house.

2. To express past actions that have finished recently:

- ✧ I have taken lunch.
- ✧ The students have taken their test.
- ✧ My brother has returned from school.

3. To denote an action beginning in the past and still continuing:

- ✧ I have worked in this office for ten years. (I am still working here.)
- ✧ We have known each other for five years.

4. Used with words such as 'just', 'already', 'ever', 'never' 'yet' , as yet etc:

- ✧ They have already taken their lunch.
- ✧ Have you ever seen a movie like this?
- ✧ He has never met any celebrity.
- ✧ The baby has not got up yet.

5. To describe a past experience connected with the present:

- ✧ He has never behaved rudely.
- ✧ They have never tasted wine.
- ✧ I have never been to Agra.
- ✧ I have never seen such a beautiful place as this.
- ✧ This is one of the most interesting books I have ever read.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with present perfect tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

1. Inever.....(see) a lion.
2. They.....(purchase) a new house.
3. I(know) him for a long time.
4. Wejust.....our dinner.(take)
5. We.....(pack) our bags. We are ready to leave.

6. He.....never.....(be) to London.
7.you.....(read) this book?
8. She.....(work) here for five years.
9. The train.....(not arrive) as yet.
10. The Principal.....already.....(warned) him many

Past Perfect Tense
Subject-Verb Pattern Subject + had + III form of Verb

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Exam ples
Affirmative Sentences	He/She/It/Singular Subject I/We You/They/Plural Subject + had+ Third form of verb	He had written a letter. They had played cricket. I had written a letter.
Negative Sentences:	He/She/It/Singular Subject I/We You/They/Plural Subject + had+ not+ Third form of verb	He had not written a letter. They had not played cricket. I had not written a letter.
Interrogative Sentences	Had+ He/She/It/Singular Subject / I/We You/ They/ Plural Subject +Third form of verb	Had he written a letter? Had they played cricket? Had I written a letter?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Had+ He/She/It/Singular Subject / I/We You/ They/ Plural Subject + not+ Third form of verb	Had he not written a letter? Had they not played cricket? Had I not written a letter?

Use of Past Perfect Tense

1. To denote an action which happened or completed before some other action took place in the past:

- ✧ The patient had died before the doctor arrived.
- ✧ The peon had rung the bell when I reached school.

2. In type-3 conditional sentences to express an unfulfilled condition in the past:

- ✧ Had you invited me, I would have attended the meeting.
- ✧ If you had worked hard, you would have succeeded.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with past perfect tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

1. The train.....(arrive) when I reached the station.
2. The boys.....(practise) well before the final match.
3. He(imagine) that he would win a lottery.
4. We.....(hope) that you would cooperate with us.
5. The chief guest.....(reach) before the function started.
6. Children ran out to play after they..... (do) their homework.
7. He fell down. I.....already..... (tell) him not to run.
8. We.....(expect) that she would visit us.
9. Rajan..... (buy) new clothes before Diwali.
10. Reema was excited to wear the new frock. She(have) always
.....(dream) of wearing it.

Future Perfect Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern: Subject + will/shall + have+ III form of Verb

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject + will+ have+ Third form of verb I/We+ shall/will+ have+ Third form of verb	He will have written a letter. They will have played cricket. I will have written a letter.
Negative Sentences:	He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject + will+ not+ have+ Third form of verb I/We+ shall/will+ not+ have+ Third form of verb	He will not have written a letter. They will not have played cricket. I will not have written a letter.
Interrogative Sentences	Will+ He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject + have+ Third form of verb Shall+ I/We + have+ Third form of verb	Will he have written a letter? Will they have played cricket? Shall I have written a letter?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Will+ He/She/It/Singular Subject/ You/They/Plural Subject +not+ have+ Third form of verb Shall+ I/We + not+ have+ Third form of verb	Will he not have written a letter? Will they not have played cricket? Shall I not have written a letter?

Use of Future Perfect Tense

1.To denote an action which will be completed at some point of time in future:

- ✍ By the end of this month, I will have completed this book.
- ✍ I will have returned by Saturday.
- ✍ We shall have submitted the report by 5 o' clock in the evening.

2. To denote an action that will be complete before some other action in future:

- ✍ She will have prepared dinner before her husband returns.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with future perfect tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

1. I(paint) this picture by tomorrow evening.
2. He(learn) all his lessons before the final exams.
3. They(repay) all their debts before leaving the city.
4. She(stitch) a new dress by coming Monday.
5. Students (decorate) their classes by the next hour.
6. The people(cast) their votes by evening.
7. The sun(set) by 6:30 pm.
8. She.....(take) her degree in three years from now.
9. The train.....(leave) the station before we reach there.
- 10.The team.....(score) two hundred runs by the thirtieth over.

Present Perfect Continuous Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern: Subject+ has/have+been+V1+ing+ since/for+ time

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He/She/It/Singular Subject+ has+ been+ First form of verb+ ing I/ We/You/They/Plural Subject+ have+ been+ First form of verb+ ing	He has been writing a letter since morning. I have been writing a letter for an hour. They have been playing cricket for two hours.
Negative Sentences:	He/She/It/Singular Subject+ has+ not+ been+ First form of verb+ ing I/ We/You/They/Plural Subject+ have + not + been+ First form of verb+ ing	He has not been writing a letter since morning. I have not been writing a letter for an hour. They have not been playing cricket for two hours.
Interrogative Sentences	Has+ He/She/It/Singular Subject+ been+ First form of verb+ ing Have+ I/ We/ You/ They/ Plural Subject+ been+ First form of verb+ ing	Has he been writing a letter since morning? Have I been writing a letter for an hour? Have they been playing cricket for two hours?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Has+ He/She/It/Singular Subject+ not+ been+ First form of verb+ ing Have+ I/ We/ You/ They/ Plural Subject+ not+ been+ First form of verb+ ing	Has he not been writing a letter since morning? Have I not been writing a letter for an hour? Have they not been playing cricket for two hours?

Use of Present Perfect Continuous Tense

1. To denote an action that started in the past and continues in present:

- ✦ It has been raining since morning.
- ✦ They have been waiting for the chief guest for one hour.

2. For repeated actions when the number of repetitions are not mentioned:

- ✦ I have been telling him not to fly kites. (frequency not mentioned)
- ✦ I have told him many times not to fly kites. (Frequency mentioned using the word 'many')

3. Drawing conclusions:

- ✦ The roads are flooded. It seems that it has been raining for long.
- ✦ He is tired. It looks that he has been working continuously.

4. To ask questions starting with 'How long' or 'Since when':

- ✦ How long have you been living in this city?
- ✦ Since when have you been serving in this office?

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with present perfect continuous tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

- The police.....(look) into the matter for two months.
- The workers are tired as they(work) since morning.
- She.....(not feel) well since yesterday.
- The doctor.....(examine) the patient for half an hour.
- They(hold) a meeting since 9 o' clock.
- The militants.....(hide) in an old house for a week.
- A strong wind.....(blow) since last night.
- The earth.....(revolve) around the sun for thousands of years.

Past Perfect Continuous Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern: Subject+ had+ been+ V1+ ing+ since/for+ time

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He/She/It/Singular Subject / I/We/ You/They/Plural Subject + had+ been +First form of verb+ ing	He had been writing a letter since morning. I had been writing a letter for an hour. They had been playing cricket for two hours.
Negative Sentences:	He/She/It/Singular Subject / I/We/ You/They/Plural Subject + had+ not+ been +First form of verb+ ing	He had not been writing a letter since morning. I had not been writing a letter for an hour. They had not been playing cricket for two hours.
Interrogative Sentences	Had+ He/She/It/Singular Subject / I/We / You/ They/ Plural Subject+ been +First form of verb+ ing	Had he been writing a letter since morning? Had I been writing a letter for an hour? Had they been playing cricket for two hours?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Had+ He/She/It/Singular Subject / I/We / You/ They/ Plural Subject+ not + been +First form of verb+ ing	Had he not been writing a letter since morning? Had I not been writing a letter for an hour? Had they not been playing cricket for two hours?

Use of Past Perfect Continuous Tense

1. To denote an action that started in the past and continued up to a certain point in the past:

- ✦ When my father reached home, I had been studying for two hours.
- ✦ He had been teaching in this school for 20 years when he got retired.
- ✦ The students were tired as they had been attending classes since morning.

2. Repeated actions in the past:

- ✦ The coach was annoyed as the players had been coming late for a month.
- ✦ The landlord was angry as the tenant had been coming late for two weeks.

3. For drawing conclusions:

- ✦ Her eyes were swollen. Apparently she had been crying all night.
- ✦ He came home tired. He had been travelling the whole day.
- ✦ The roads were flooded. It had been raining all night.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with past perfect continuous tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

- The police.....(look) into the matter for two months when the case was closed.
- The workers were tired as they(work) since morning.
- She.....(not feel) well since morning, so she went to consult a doctor.
- The farmers were happy when it rained. They(wait) for rain for more than a month.
- They(hold) a meeting since 9 o'clock.
- The boys(swim) in the pool for an hour when the instructor asked them to come out.
- The militants.....(hide) in an old house for a week when they were shot dead by the police.
- My mother.....(fast) since Monday when the doctor came.
- The phone.....(ring) for ten minutes when my father received the call.

Future Perfect Continuous Tense

Subject-Verb Pattern: Subject+ will/shall+ have+ been+ V1+ ing+ since/for+ time

Types of Sentence	S-V Pattern	Examples
Affirmative Sentences	He/ She/It/ Singular Subject/ You/ They/ Plural Subject+ Will+ have+ been +First form of verb+ ing I/We+ shall/will+ have+ been+ First form of verb+ ing	He will have been writing a letter since morning. I shall/will have been writing a letter for an hour. They will have been playing cricket for two hours.
Negative Sentences:	He/ She/It/ Singular Subject/ You/ They/ Plural Subject+ Will+ not+ have+ been +First form of verb+ ing I/We+ shall/will+ not+ have+ been+ First form of verb+ ing	He will not have been writing a letter since morning. I shall/will not have been writing a letter for an hour. They will not have been playing cricket for two hours.
Interrogative Sentences	Will+ He/ She/It/ Singular Subject/ You/ They/ Plural Subject+ have+ been +First form of verb+ ing Shall+ I/ We+ have+ been+ First form of verb+ ing	Will he have been writing a letter since morning? Shall I have been writing a letter for an hour? Will they have been playing cricket for two hours?
Interrogative Negative Sentences	Will+ He/ She/It/ Singular Subject/ You/ They/ Plural Subject+ not+ have+ been +First form of verb+ ing Shall+ I/ We+ not+ have+ been+ First form of verb+ ing	Will he not have been writing a letter since morning? Shall I not have been writing a letter for an hour? Will they not have been playing cricket for two hours?

Use of Future Perfect Continuous Tense

Future perfect tense is used to describe an action that will be in progress over a period of time at some point in future. This tense is rarely used.

- ✍ By the end of this year, I will have been practising law for two years.
- ✍ By December, he will have been working on this project for six months.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with future perfect continuous tense of the verbs given in the brackets.

- The workers.....(work) since morning when it strikes 5.
- They(hold) a meeting since 9 o'clock when they disperse.
- The boys(swim) in the pool for an hour when the instructor asks them to come out.
- My mother.....(fast) since Monday when the doctor comes.
- The phone.....(ring) for ten minutes when my father receives the call.
- The workers(protest) for a month by Tuesday.
- By evening, the players.....(practising) for five hours.
- By next week, they(live) in this house for ten years.

All Tenses

	Present	Past	Future
Simple	Sub+V1 (s/es) or Sub+V1 He writes a letter. He does not write a letter. Does he write a letter? Does he not write a letter	Sub+V2 He wrote a letter. He did not write a letter. Did he write a letter? Did he not write a letter?	Sub+will/shall+V1 He will write a letter. He will not write a letter. Will he write a letter? Will he not write a letter?
Continuous	Sub+ is/am/are+V1+ing He is writing a letter. He is not writing a letter. Is he writing a letter? Is he not writing a letter?	Sub+was/were+V1+ing He was writing a letter. He was not writing a letter. Was he writing a letter? Was he not writing a letter?	Sub+ will/shall+ be + V1+ing He will be writing a letter. He will not be writing a letter. Will he be writing a letter? Will he not be writing a letter?
Perfect	Sub+ has/have+V3 He has written a letter. He has not written a letter. Has he written a letter? Has he not written a letter?	Sub+ had+V3 He had written a letter. He had not written a letter. Had he written a letter? Had he not written a letter?	Sub+ will/shall+have+V3 He will have written a letter. He will not have written a letter. Will he have written a letter? Will he not have written a letter?
Perfect Continuous	Sub+ has/have+been+V1+ing+ since/ for +time He has been writing a letter for two hours. He has not been writing a letter since 10 o'clock. Has he been writing a letter for two hours? Has he not been writing a letter for ten minutes?	Sub+ had+been+V1+ing+ since/ for+ time He had been writing a letter for two hours. He had not been writing a letter since 10 o'clock. Had he been writing a letter for two hours? Had he not been writing a letter since 10 o'clock?	Sub+will/shall+ have+been+ V1+ing + since/for+ time He will have been writing a letter for two hours. He will not have been writing a letter since 10 o'clock. Will he have been writing a letter for two hours? Will he not have been writing a letter for ten minutes?